2.2.2 Nutrient requirement during lactation

a) Energy

The additional energy needed for lactation is drawn from maternal adipose tissue stores lay down during pregnancy. Depending on the adequacy of the stores, additional energy input may be needed in the lactating women's daily diet. This is the reason nutrition expert committee (2010) prescribed additional calories 600 and 520 respectively for 0 - 6 months and 7 to 12 months.

b) Protein

During lactation, protein requirement has been computed on the basis of secretion of protein in milk. An additional daily intake of 22.9 g for the first 6 months and 15.2 g during 7-12 months of lactation is prescribed. If energy or protein is lacking, there will be a reduction in milk volume rather than in milk quality.

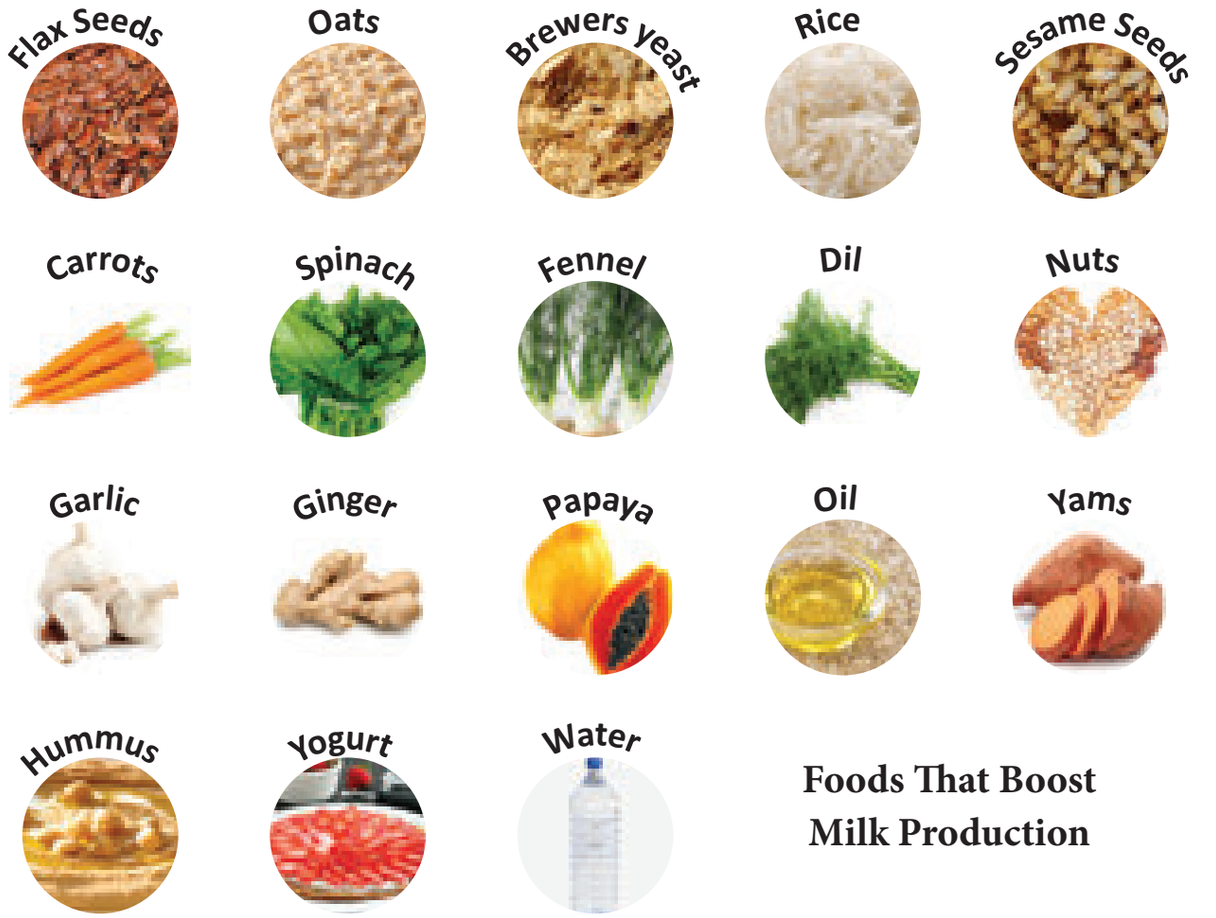
c) Minerals

i) Calcium

The increased amount of calcium that is required during gestation for mineralization of the foetal skeleton is now diverted into the mother's milk production. Both during pregnancy and lactation 1200 mg has been prescribed by ICMR. The retention of dietary calcium in lactating women is about 30 %, hence an extra amount of 600 mg is prescribed. About one litre of milk or milk products should be given to lactating mother to meet 1200 mg of calcium.

ii) Iron

The iron requirement during lactation is 25 mg per day. The baby is born with the relatively large reserve of iron since milk is not a good source of iron. A good allowance of iron in the mother's diet during lactation does not convey additional iron to the Infant. Iron requirement during lactation is the sum



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